



MUSICAL BEGINNINGS

A piano belonging to the Pärt family, now at the Arvo Pärt Center in Laulasmaa. The composer's mother liked to start the day by playing music by Bach.

Exile and return

Pärt remained a thorn in the side of the Soviet musical establishment, and by 1980 was so pilloried by his critics that he was forced to leave Estonia with his wife and two sons. They lived at first in Vienna, moving in 1981 to West Berlin, where he was granted German citizenship. With the fall of the Soviet bloc, he renewed his contacts with his homeland, and for a while divided his time between Germany and Estonia, before moving back permanently to the coastal village of Laulasmaa, near Tallinn, in 2010.